

Chapter 23_2 - Divorce Certificate

Fu Sixue stood frozen for five seconds after hearing Feng Yue's words. Seeing her incredulous expression, Feng Yue smiled and pulled out the freshly issued divorce certificate from her bag, tossing it to her.

Fu Sixue caught it frantically, as if holding a hot potato. Looking at the little booklet in her hands, the bright words "Divorce Certificate" didn't look fake at all.

Fu Sixue opened her mouth to say something but couldn't get any words out. After a long silence, she could only raise her thumb toward Feng Yue.

"That's so like you!"

Feng Yue sank into the soft sofa with complete relaxation. "I'm not someone who likes to drag things out. When I want something, I'll work hard to get it."

"That's true. Whether it was pursuing A-Lin or getting divorced now, your efficiency is unmatched." Fu Sixue also sighed deeply and raised her glass. "Come on, let's celebrate your return to singlehood."

Feng Yue smiled with curved eyebrows and lightly clinked glasses with her. "Thank you."

After that, Fu Sixue didn't bring up anything about Yan Lin again. The two of them chatted like ordinary friends who hadn't seen each other in a long time, talking about everything under the sun.

In the evening, since neither of them really wanted to go out, Feng Yue ordered hotpot delivery. They sat in the dining room around the steaming hotpot and had a satisfying meal.

Fu Sixue seemed to have found someone to vent to, launching into a tirade about how difficult life abroad was and how much she wanted to return to China.

Since Feng Yue couldn't drink alcohol, she substituted with juice, but Fu Sixue, who had opened up the floodgates of conversation, drank quite a bit and ended up staying overnight at Feng Yue's place.

Feng Yue hadn't considered that someone might stay over, so the guest room was still cluttered with her miscellaneous items and hadn't been tidied up. So that night, the two of them had to make do together.

The next morning, when Fu Sixue woke up tormented by a hangover headache and saw Feng Yue lying beside her, she felt a slight pang of guilt toward Yan Lin.

A-Lin, I didn't mean to sleep with your wife!

From the day she got the divorce certificate, Feng Yue's solitary life got on track, and she began slowly planning the script for her first video shoot.

She had arranged her kitchen to be very pleasing to the eye, and the refrigerator was packed with ingredients—some brought by Mother Feng, others purchased by the residential property manager at Feng Yue's request.

Although everything was ready, Feng Yue still had no idea what kind of video to shoot.

So to find inspiration, she visited Zhou Qiongqiong's theater again, but this time she wasn't alone—she went with Wen Zhen.

Originally, Feng Yue was going to go by herself, but Zhou Qiongqiong's production was so popular that she couldn't buy tickets on her own, so she could only contact Zhou Qiongqiong to ask if she had any family tickets left.

Zhou Qiongqiong did have two family tickets originally, but her college classmate had contacted her in advance, so she had already given those tickets away.

However, Zhou Qiongqiong also suggested a solution—she told Feng Yue to contact Wen Zhen. As the daughter of the theater troupe's director, it would be easy for Wen Zhen to bring someone into the theater.

Sure enough, after receiving Feng Yue's call, Wen Zhen drove directly to the bottom of her apartment building to pick her up.

It wasn't as hot recently, and since Feng Yue had a weak constitution, she wore a jacket over her dress. When she got in the car and saw Wen Zhen still wearing a deep V-neck camisole, she was a bit surprised.

"Sister Wen Zhen, why are you wearing so little? It's been getting cooler lately, hasn't it?" Feng Yue closed the car door and handed Wen Zhen a cup of fruit tea she had made at home—she had also brought some for Zhou Qiongqiong.

"Thank you." Wen Zhen took the fruit tea and had a sip before explaining, "I have a jacket in the car. I was just feeling a bit warm in the car earlier."

"Oh, I see. Remember to take it when we get out—the theater will definitely be cold if they have the air conditioning on."

"Got it." With that, Wen Zhen started the car.

Feng Yue's apartment was quite a distance from Zhou Qiongqiong's theater—they had to cross the city, requiring about half an hour of driving.

Wen Zhen was afraid she'd be bored, so she turned on the car's audio system and then chatted with Feng Yue intermittently.

"By the way, I remember you've seen Xiao Zhou's¹ play before, haven't you?" Wen Zhen gripped the steering wheel with both hands, her fingertips unconsciously tapping on it.

Feng Yue smiled somewhat embarrassedly. "Didn't I mention before that I wanted to make videos? I still haven't figured out what kind to shoot. So I thought I'd go out and find some inspiration. I really like that confidence and pride Qiongqiong has when she's on stage, and also..."

Feng Yue pursed her lips. "I don't really have other friends."

Wen Zhen chuckled softly, somewhat disapprovingly. "Why would you think that? As long as you're willing to make friends, you'll have many friends. Feng Yue, you're far better than you realize. So don't sell yourself short."

Feng Yue was startled by these words, then smiled and nodded vigorously. The melancholy in her heart was swept away, and she rolled down the car window, letting the cold wind from outside rush into the car.

"Oh, by the way, when I was helping you adjust your camera settings before, I wanted to ask—why did you suddenly move to Song He Bay²?" Wen Zhen asked. "I heard from Shuang Shuang³ that you used to live in the villa district at Jiao Yu Court⁴, right?"

Feng Yue was in a good mood and didn't plan to hide her situation from this hard-won group of friends.

So after thinking for a moment, she said: "The place at Jiao Yu Court belonged to my wife—that Yan Lin you met before. We got divorced, so I moved out."

Wen Zhen hadn't expected this outcome for the two of them. Although she had felt that their relationship wasn't quite normal when they had dinner together, that was other people's private business, so she hadn't asked much about it.

Looking back now, perhaps the two of them already had signs of impending divorce at that time.

"Sorry, I didn't know," Wen Zhen said.

Feng Yue turned to look at her with a smile. "It's fine. I think getting divorced is pretty good."

"Hah, that's true. Single life is quite happy." Wen Zhen raised an eyebrow. "Then I wish you happiness in your singlehood."

"Hahaha, thank you. I remember Xiao Xue said the same thing to me when she found out about this."

The two chatted about whether single life was happy or not for a while before Wen Zhen remembered what Feng Yue had mentioned earlier.

"I didn't know before that you had moved to a new place—I thought you were just temporarily staying at Song He Bay. Now that I know, how about we organize a small housewarming party? Qiongqiong and I could come warm your house, and if possible, you could also make a video about it."

Feng Yue blinked and fell into thought, as if considering the feasibility of this suggestion.

Wen Zhen didn't interrupt her, letting her think quietly.

After a while, Feng Yue suddenly clapped her hands and said happily: "Great! The first video will be about a housewarming party for moving—it can represent the start of my new life too!"

The two wanted to discuss this topic more, but they had already arrived at the theater entrance. So they decided to wait until after Zhou Qiongqiong's performance to plan this together.

Wen Zhen's seats weren't the best but weren't bad either. After entering the venue, the two quieted down and immersed themselves completely in the dance drama performance.

Once Zhou Qiongqiong stepped onto the stage, she began to radiate incomparable brilliance, even making Feng Yue feel that compared to those stars active under the spotlight, Zhou Qiongqiong was in no way inferior.

Zhou Qiongqiong was dazzling, which made Feng Yue, this casual friend, feel an indescribable sense of pride.

Look—that most captivating actress on stage was her friend, Feng Yue's friend.

Once immersed in the dance drama, time passed very quickly. Feng Yue felt like she had just sat down, but the entire production had already reached its conclusion.

Wen Zhen and Feng Yue didn't wait for all the actors to finish their curtain calls before leaving. Instead, they left their seats after the performance ended, and then Wen Zhen led Feng Yue to the backstage area.

Wen Zhen's face was clearly a living pass—they didn't even need to wear staff badges on their chests to freely enter and exit the backstage area.

They waited in the rest room for a while before the late-arriving Zhou Qiongqiong finally appeared.

This time, neither of them had brought any gifts, but Feng Yue had brought the fruit tea she made for Zhou Qiongqiong.

"Darling, you're so thoughtful! Did you know I've been having a hard time dieting recently, so instead of bringing milk tea, you brought fruit tea?" Zhou Qiongqiong happily accepted the fruit tea and took a sip. Only after getting some sugar did she feel like she had come back to life.

Feng Yue looked at her with a smile. "You're already so thin, why are you still dieting?"

Zhou Qiongqiong looked dejected. "The troupe is rehearsing a new production. The protagonist needs to be 'delicate as a willow in the wind,' with a waist that can be encircled by one hand⁵, so that's why I'm dieting."

Feng Yue patted her consolingly. "That's tough, that's tough."

"It's okay, as long as you come see me more often." Zhou Qiongqiong shook the fruit tea in her hand, signaling to Feng Yue not to forget to bring food.

Wen Zhen laughingly nudged Zhou Qiongqiong with her elbow. "Stop being silly and listen to what Feng Yue has to say."

Reminded by Wen Zhen, Feng Yue snapped back to attention and told Zhou Qiongqiong about what they had discussed in the car.

After hearing this, Zhou Qiongqiong nodded eagerly. "I think that's a great idea! How about in a few days? This production is almost over, and I have a few days off."

The three of them hit it off immediately and chatted for quite a while more. Finally, Zhou Qiongqiong remembered something and said: "Oh right, you should invite Little Devil⁶ too. She has such a good relationship with you two as a married couple—a housewarming party needs her there too!"

Feng Yue was startled, then remembered that Zhou Qiongqiong didn't know about her divorce from Yan Lin yet, and still thought this move was something she and Yan Lin had done together.

"Ah, I forgot to tell you." Feng Yue smiled mischievously. "I divorced Yan Lin, so that's why I moved."

Zhou Qiongqiong: ...?

"Di-divorced?!" Zhou Qiongqiong looked at Feng Yue, then at Wen Zhen, looking completely unable to believe it.

Who the hell would believe this! She had been secretly envious at the class reunion not long ago, saying that watching Yan Lin and Feng Yue made her believe in love again.

But before she had even believed in it for long, this love had fucking ended tragically!

Footnotes:

¹ "Xiao Zhou" (小周) - "Xiao" (小) is a diminutive prefix used for nicknames, showing familiarity and affection.

² "Song He Bay" (颂和湾) - The name of Feng Yue's new residential complex.

³ "Shuang Shuang" (霜霜) - This appears to be a nickname for Dai Shuangshuang, Yan Lin's younger cousin.

⁴ "Jiao Yu Court" (骄御庭) - The name of the upscale villa district where Feng Yue and Yan Lin used to live together.

⁵ "Delicate as a willow in the wind, with a waist that can be encircled by one hand" (弱柳扶风，小腰要盈盈一握) - Traditional Chinese poetic descriptions of feminine beauty, emphasizing extreme delicacy and slenderness.

⁶ "Little Devil" (小魔王) - Zhou Qiongqiong's nickname for Dai Shuangshuang, suggesting she has a mischievous personality.

